



FRANCIS CRICK & JAMES WATSON

English
molecular biologist
1916–2004

American
molecular biologist
1928–present

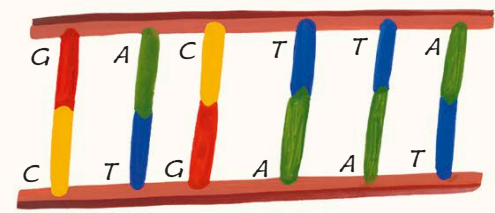
In a laboratory in Cambridge, UK, Francis Crick and James Watson had also been racing to understand the structure of DNA. Rather than trying to photograph the molecule, they conducted tests to find which chemicals DNA was made from. Then, they made models to try to figure out how these chemicals fit together—like giant, complicated, 3-D jigsaw puzzles!

In 1953, a scientist from Rosalind's laboratory showed Rosalind's photo of DNA to James. He raced back to the lab so that he and Francis could build 3-D models of a double helix. All the different chemicals in DNA could finally be fit together, thanks to the work of Rosalind, Francis, and James.



The secret of life

The discovery made by Rosalind, Francis, and James helped us determine how DNA carries instructions for all the proteins that build a living thing. Learning to read this code has allowed us to use science in new ways, such as to catch criminals, defeat viruses, and save more lives with medicine.



A coded sequence of DNA is made up of four chemicals—Adenine (A), Thymine (T), Guanine (G), and Cytosine (C). A always pairs with T, and G always pairs with C.